

Contract Acquisition Strategy, Pricing & Execution Review (CASPER)

All new DAF acquisitions meeting CASPER thresholds | Replaces legacy clearance process



ADMINISTRATIVE INFORMATION

DATE OF INITIAL REVIEW	PROGRAM / CONTRACT NAME	
TOTAL ESTIMATED VALUE (TEV)	SOLICITATION / CONTRACT NO. (IF ASSIGNED)	
PORTFOLIO TYPE	ACQUISITION TYPE	CONTRACT TYPE

Scope Check (\$3.1): Confirm this action is not exempt before proceeding. Exempt types include: purely administrative/funding modifications, competitive MAC IDIQ orders without evaluation criteria or T&C changes, non-competitive orders against single-award IDIQs per basic contract terms, AbilityOne procurements, and alternate authority awards not resulting in a FAR-based contract.

1. CORE ACQUISITION TEAM

CASPER RISK ADVISOR (CRA) AUTHORITY LEVEL	
CASPER RISK ADVISOR (CRA) — NAME / RANK	CRA ORGANIZATION / OFFICE SYMBOL
PROCURING CONTRACTING OFFICER (PCO) — NAME / RANK	PCO ORGANIZATION / OFFICE SYMBOL
KEY STAKEHOLDERS PRESENT (optional)	

PHASE I — ACQUISITION STRATEGY REVIEW (ASR)

Goal: Are we pursuing the right contracting approach? | Timing: Early planning, prior to finalizing the Acquisition Plan

i Phase I is **MANDATORY** for all acquisitions meeting CASPER thresholds. The CRA should engage during existing reviews (e.g., Acquisition Strategy Panel, Early Strategy & Issues Session) where possible. At conclusion of the ASR, the CRA will determine whether Phase II (PNR) is required, limited in scope, or waived.

2. STRATEGIC DECISIONS & MITIGATIONS

MISSION & REQUIREMENT

MARKET STRATEGY & COMMERCIAL SOLUTION APPROACH

CONTRACT TYPE, CLIN STRUCTURE & EVALUATION CRITERIA



IP Continuity Book (§5.3.2): Archive all IP negotiations, executed licensing agreements, and data/software rights decisions now. This record must be established at Phase I and maintained through award to preserve institutional knowledge and prevent future vendor lock-in.

3. RISK ASSESSMENT & CRA DIRECTION

OVERALL RISK RATING — SELECT ONE



RED

HIGH RISK

HQ/CRA Mitigation Req.



AMBER

MED/LOW RISK

Managed Locally



GREEN

LOW RISK

Routine Management

CRITICAL RISK ACCEPTED & MITIGATION PLAN

CRA DIRECTION

PHASE I SIGN-OFF — The CRA and PCO sign below in acknowledgment of the risk assessment and CRA direction documented above, regardless of risk rating.

CASPER Risk Advisor (CRA):

Name / Rank

Title / Position

Procuring Contracting Officer (PCO):

Name / Rank

Title / Position

PHASE II — PRICING & NEGOTIATION REVIEW (PNR)

Goal: Is our pricing and negotiation approach sound? | Timing: Prior to entering negotiations or establishing competitive range

PHASE II TRIGGER (Select One):

- ☐ **BYPASSED — No Phase II review required**
CRA has waived this phase. Document rationale in Phase I CRA Direction block above.
- ☐ **REQUIRED — A Phase II huddle will be conducted at the CRDD**
Complete Section 4 below. CRA touchpoints during PNR depend on the negotiation strategy.

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Complete Section 4 only if Phase II is **REQUIRED**. If **BYPASSED**, document the written waiver rationale in the field below (§3.2.1), then proceed to Phase III.
Note: CRA participation in a required DPCAP peer review satisfies this phase — no separate huddle needed (§3.0).

PHASE II WAIVER RATIONALE (written waiver required — retain in contract file per §3.2.1)

PHASE III — CONTRACT EXECUTION REVIEW (CER) [OPTIONAL]

Goal: Is the contract on track and are risks being mitigated? | Timing: Post-award, triggered at CRA discretion

PHASE III TRIGGER (Select One):

- ☐ **NOT TRIGGERED — No CER required. CASPER process concluded at Phase II.**
Both parties sign the closure block below.
- ☐ **TRIGGERED — A CER huddle has been directed by the CRA**
Complete Section 5 below. Driven by specific post-award risks (protest, performance slip, IP dispute).

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Complete Section 5 only if Phase III is **TRIGGERED**. The CER is post-award and driven by specific risks identified during ASR or PNR. If NOT TRIGGERED: both parties sign the closure block at the end of this document.

CASPER QUICK REFERENCE

STOPLIGHT RISK RATINGS

RED
HIGH

High Risk — violation of law, regulation, DAF Policy, or critical mission flaw.
→ **Requires active HQ / CRA mitigation.**

AMBER
MED/LOW

Medium Risk — significant execution hurdle. Not illegal but likely leads to cost/schedule/performance failure.
→ **Managed locally.**

GREEN
LOW

Low Risk — friction or inefficiency that creates admin burden but does not threaten mission success.
→ **Routine management.**

COMMENT CATEGORIES (C / S / A)

C
CRIT.

High Risk: Violation of law, regulation, DAF Policy or critical flaw. **STOP — Must fix.** Requires CRA concurrence on solution.

S
SUBST.

Med/Low Risk: Threat to contract execution, not violating law. **DISCUSS** — CO authorized to resolve. Must be addressed. Not a cause for non-concurrence if uncorrected.

A
ADMIN

Administrative: grammar, punctuation, style. **FIX AS NEEDED** — Does not require a formal response or CRA concurrence.

CRA AUTHORITY THRESHOLDS

CRA ROLE	OPERATIONAL	ENTERPRISE	PEO	PAE
COCO / Designee	≥\$5M – ≤\$10M	≥\$10M – ≤\$50M	≥\$10M – ≤\$100M	≥\$10M
SCO / Designee ¹	>\$10M – <\$1B	>\$50M – <\$1B	>\$100M – <\$1B	Special Interest ²
HCA / Designee	Special Interest ² or ≥\$1B — applies across all portfolio types			

¹ SCO also serves as CRA for IDIQ contracts ≥\$1B (Operational/Enterprise/PEO) not establishing pricing in the basic contract. ² Special Interest may be designated by the SAE for any action regardless of value. All designees must be ≥1 level above the CO.